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Iraqis light candles at the shrine of Abdul Qadir Al Gailani to mark the birthday of Prophet Mohammed (PBUH), in Baghdad, on Monday.
AP

UAE leaders celebrate Prophet’s legacy

President and Prime Minister’s messages talk of mercy, compassion, and humanity

DUBAI

UAE’s leaders took to social media yesterday with special messages to commemorate the birthday of Prophet Mohammed (PBUH).
President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan wrote on X: “On the anniversary of the birth of the Prophet (peace be upon him), we reflect on the legacy he left behind, built on mercy, compassion, and tolerance, and one that raised goodness to a noble and enduring purpose. We hope for our nation and its people to remain ever protected, and for our region and the world to be blessed with lasting peace and security.”
His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai also wrote a heartfelt note on X. “Congratulations to the Muslim world on the anniversary of the birth of our beloved Prophet and intercessor, Mohammed, peace be upon him, the Messenger of humanity, the noblest of mankind and a mercy to the worlds. On this blessed occasion, we pray to Allah Almighty to bless the Muslim world with goodness, peace, security and stability,” Sheikh Mohammed tweeted.
Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court and Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, also shared posts on the occasion.
— Gulf News Report

Dubai to open 26 new private education institutions in 2026–27

Expansion comes as Dubai’s private education sector records 4.6% growth

DUBAI
BY CHRISTIAN BORBON
Senior Web Editor

Dubai’s private education sector is set to expand further in the 2026-27 academic year, with 26 new institutions to open across the emirate, including 17 early childhood centres, seven schools and two higher education institutions.
The new schools will add nearly 17,000 seats, while the early childhood centres (ECCs) will provide more than 1,700 additional places, giving families and students more education options across the city.
The expansion comes as Dubai’s private education sector recorded annual growth of 4.6 per cent across early childhood education, schools and higher education over the past three academic years, despite the exceptional circumstances experienced during the 2025-26 academic year.
Of the seven new private schools, four will offer the UK curriculum and three the International Baccalaureate, adding a combined 16,846 places.
They include Dubai campuses of British schools Harrow International School Dubai, Queen Elizabeth’s School Dubai Sports City and Rugby School Dubai.
21 schools added
Dubai’s private school sector has added 21 schools over the past three years, with enrolment growing by 3.1 per cent during the period.

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The ECC sector will expand with 17 new centres offering a range of curricula, including the UK’s Early Years Foundation Stage (EYFS), Montessori, Ontario, French and Indian programmes.
The centres will add more than 1,700 places, expanding access to early learning across the emirate.
Over the past three years, 87 new early childhood centres have opened in Dubai, with enrolment growing by 2.6 per cent.
Peking University HSBC Business School, ranked 47th globally in the QS rankings, will launch MBA and EMBA programmes in Dubai in January 2027. The American University of Beirut’s Dubai campus is scheduled to open in September 2026.
Eleven new higher education institutions have opened in Dubai over the past three years, with enrolment growing by 29 per cent.
The number of teachers working in Dubai’s private education sector has grown by 17.5 per cent over the past three academic years.
Aisha Miran, Director General of KHDA, said: “Every new early childhood centre, school and higher education institution expands opportunities for learners at every stage of their educational journey.”
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GARGASH: IRAN MUST WORK WITH GCC TO END THE WAR

Attacks have deepened its isolation, he says

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Iran must work with Gulf Arab countries to de-escalate tensions and find a political way out of the war rather than target them, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said yesterday.
“As the US-Iran confrontation enters a new phase, characterised by escalating economic pressure, ending attempts to dominate the Strait of Hormuz and moving beyond the memorandum of understanding stage, we reiterate that Iran’s aggression against the GCC countries missed its target,” Gargash said on X.
“Instead, it deepened Tehran’s predicament and was a grave strategic miscalculation that further increased its isolation and weakened its position.”
Gargash added: “The path out of this war does not lie in targeting the GCC countries, but in working with them to create the conditions for de-escalation and to seek a political way out of the war.”
Oman holds Iran talks
His comments came as Oman’s Foreign Minister Badr Al Busaidi met Iranian counterpart Abbas Araghchi in Tehran, as the two countries seek a way to regulate transit through the Strait of Hormuz.
Tensions remained high in the waterway. UK Maritime Trade Operations reported that an oil tanker was struck by an unidentified projectile about nine

GULF AVIATION REBOUNDS

Gulf aviation is recovering faster than initially expected six months after the US-Iran war disrupted regional airspace, although the financial impact continues to weigh on airlines, hotels and insurers.
Dubai is on course to end the year close to its pre-war trajectory, with aviation analysts saying the recovery has been “faster than many expected.” Doha and Abu Dhabi have also rebuilt their networks rapidly, while connecting passengers have returned to account for around half of Dubai’s traffic.
The recovery remains uneven, however. Gulf low-cost carriers are operating at around 90 per cent of their 2023 capacity, helped by the faster return of regional and point-to-point demand.
Full-service network carriers have faced a slower recovery, with capacity still around 20-25 per cent below 2025 levels. Industry analysts do not expect their full capacity to return this year.
— Dhanusha Gokulan, Chief Reporter

nautical miles northeast of Ash Shishah, Oman.
US President Donald Trump, meanwhile, said the US Navy had removed or detonated all mines in international waters of the Strait. He warned that vessels laying new mines would be “immediately and systematically destroyed”.
China pushes back
Washington also stepped up economic pressure on Tehran, with Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announcing new sanctions on Monday and warning countries doing business with Iran to sever financial ties or face US retaliation.
“We are level-setting with every country to tell them our expectations. We know who they are. They know who they are,” Bessent said, warning that “the hammer of US Treasury actions” could fall on them.
Calling the campaign “Operation Economic Outcast”, Bessent

said Trump had been making calls to world leaders seeking an end to dealings with Iran.
China, a key Iranian economic partner, said it “firmly opposes illegal unilateral sanctions” and would take necessary measures to safeguard its interests.
Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, meanwhile, told Pakistan Army Chief Asim Munir that Washington must change its approach towards Tehran, saying reliance on “coercion and bullying” would only complicate diplomatic efforts.
Trump also called on Tehran to halt executions of people allegedly involved in protests earlier this year, describing the situation as a “humanitarian crisis of epic proportions”.
Separately, the US Secret Service said it was aware of an Iranian state media video that appeared to threaten the life of Trump’s youngest son, Barron, and was investigating the matter.
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